

Offline used-API golden oracle

This S02 developer tool records actual legacy handlers without starting the service, MongoDB, collectors, live providers, geocoders or notification sends. It supplies the frozen oracle for later server2 ports; it does not certify those ports or the deployed service.

Prerequisites and safety

Use Node **16.20.2**, Python **3.11+**, and npm compatible with the checked-in lock. The legacy dependencies are deliberately pinned for this test process, not proposed as production dependencies. Work from the repository root. The isolated dependency installation uses network access to the package registry; handler execution admits only explicitly registered local 127.0.0.1 HTTP ports. Run in a clean, non-secret environment. Do not start `server/app.js` or any `/gather` endpoint.

The only outside executable is the declared `server/test/offline/golden-record.js`. The server2 consumer validates that exact canonical path and its hash, then spawns it for verification. All additional legacy source reads occur within the recorder. This manually reviewed exception is not a server2 runtime import or permission to execute arbitrary outside files.

Verify the baseline

The independent golden CI entrypoint creates and removes a temporary dependency prefix. It installs with lifecycle scripts, audit and funding requests disabled, runs negative contract tests, and records twice in fresh Node processes:

```
python3.11 server2/tools/golden/ci.py --install
```

The two recordings must match each other and the checked-in `server2/tests/golden/records.json` byte for byte. A successful run reports 19 observed groups, 62 actual wire cases and 11 backend families. Missing coverage, altered raw bytes, status, headers or source/dependency hashes fails verification. The artifact keeps response bodies in base64, so JSON whitespace and non-JSON bodies are preserved.

For an existing isolated install, explicitly set its `node_modules` prefix and Node executable:

```
NODE_PATH=/tmp/my-golden-deps/node_modules \
GOLDEN_NODE=/path/to/node-16.20.2 \
python3.11 server2/tools/golden/verify.py verify
```

The following capture is from actual CLI help and a completed offline verification; host-specific paths are omitted from the capture. The PDF version contains the same procedure and evidence.

```
$ python3.11 server2/tools/golden/verify.py --help
usage: verify.py [-h] [--output OUTPUT] [--node NODE] {record,verify}

Explicit offline recording/verification. Never silently updates the baseline.

positional arguments:
  {record,verify}

options:
  -h, --help            show this help message and exit
  --output OUTPUT
  --node NODE
usage: ci.py [-h] [--install]

Owned golden CI entrypoint, independently wired from foundation CI.

$ NODE_PATH=<isolated prefix> GOLDEN_NODE=<Node16.20.2> python3.11 server2/tools/golden/verify.py verify
{"outcome": "passed", "groups": 19, "cases": 62, "backend_coverage": ["domestic-v000901",
"domestic-v000902", "domestic-v000903", "nation", "push", "special", "town-v000705", "town-v000803",
"world-v000901", "world-v000902", "world-v000903"], "sha256":
"a7e87338f44072e71834f5663461d6a2ccdc226d91adafa06b61dfcc993eb157"}

Actual separate smoke: 62 cases; baseline byte-equal; live-mode rejected before output.
```

Inspect or deliberately update a baseline

Recording requires an explicit output directory and never overwrites the committed baseline:

```
NODE_PATH=/tmp/my-golden-deps/node_modules \
python3.11 server2/tools/golden/verify.py record \
--node /path/to/node-16.20.2 --output /tmp/my-golden-review
```

Review that output against the committed artifact, including provenance, request, raw body, status and every header. A source or fixture change requires explaining the actual contract change and independently reviewing the new recording. Copy an approved recording into the baseline only as an explicit source change, then repeat verification, placement and CI checks. The recorder pins the source baseline revision rather than using the current Git HEAD, so committing tooling does not change output.

Coverage and interpretation

The accepted 2026-08-23..2026-09-22 UTC traffic CSV has 220,583 requests in 19 method/path groups. It establishes inclusion only. Supplementary cases exercise the real domestic v000901/v000902/v000903 and world backends, town, nation, warnings and push assembly; gateway stubs do not substitute for those cases.

All six master locales and requested temperature, wind, pressure, distance, precipitation and air unit variants execute actual controllers. Cases include OPTIONS, actual ETag/304, malformed inputs, geocoder auth/quota/empty results, non-JSON gateway errors, yesterday/midnight, missing history, covered/missing/old-row POP, week-old warning types2/3 and type4's actual 19-hour boundary. Exactly +19 hours is included; +19 hours plus1ms is absent in the frozen legacy behavior.

Failure-only v000705 POST push and v000901 nation use fixed dependency failures through real handlers. The current v000705 town route, including its real version index, produces an empty200 with the frozen inputs and has no ETag. Historical traffic200 does not establish its payload. These limitations are explicit, not synthetic success fixtures.

The pinned source baseline is f568508da68d408a282752f55614407899631c88, including the legacy #2684 push recovery changes. AK's future server2 no-resend and new-registration-only decisions are recorded separately as intended differences; legacy goldens are not silently rewritten to encode them. Source/deployed revision drift remains a cutover gate.

Failures and limits

A raw-body/hash error, inventory gap, source drift or byte mismatch exits nonzero. Inspect an explicit fresh recording rather than automatically accepting new bytes. Missing Node/dependencies or denied local sockets is an environment failure, not a parity result. A direct recorder invocation rejects live-mode hints before output. The consumer strips host provider/storage hints and never uses them to fetch data.

Dependency responses are fixed inputs and some existing offline fixtures are synthetic. Real assembly and HTTP middleware execute, but this does not establish provider availability, production credentials, every geographic location, concurrent locale races, complete deployed parity or a new server2 response. The JavaScript guards are a bounded verification safety mechanism, not an adversarial OS sandbox. Resource placement checks supplement manual review and do not prove arbitrary computed paths safe.

The foundation workflow retains fmt, clippy, Rust tests, placement tests, release build and separate release-binary smoke. The additive golden job invokes only its owned CI endpoint. Essential golden bytes, selected CLI capture and this editable/PDF manual are retained in Git; raw stage runs remain ignored local reports. No broad reports upload is added.